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CAPSTONE PROJECT CONCEPT PAPER

LYDO CONNECT: YOUTH INFORMATION, ENGAGEMENT, AND TRANSPARENCY MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

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Area of Specialization (Please check)	☒ Software / Application Development (Web, Mobile, Desktop) ☐ Game Development ☐ Mobile Application Development ☒ Database Management and Information Systems ☐ Networking and Infrastructure ☐ Cybersecurity / Information Security ☒ Data Analytics / Data Science ☐ Artificial Intelligence / Intelligent Systems ☐ Internet of Things (IoT) ☒ Educational Technology / E-Government / Domain-Specific Systems
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INTRODUCTION / BACKGROUND - NAMI

The youth are often regarded as the “*hope of the nation*,” reflecting their important role in shaping the future of society. In the Philippines, Local Youth Development Offices (LYDOs) are institutionalized through the Republic Act No. 10742, also known as the Sangguniang Kabataan (SK) Reform Act of 2015, and its amended version, Republic Act No. 11768. Under Sections 25 and 26 of RA 10742, LYDOs are mandated to formulate and implement the Local Youth Development Plan (LYDP) and manage youth programs aligned with the Youth Organization Registration Program (YORP), ensuring structured youth participation and governance. These mandates establish LYDOs as key institutions responsible for coordinating youth development initiatives, leadership training, and community engagement at the local level.

Currently, most of the Local Youth Development Offices in Metro Manila rely on a combination of social media platforms, manual records, and third-party tools which create significant

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operational and governance limitations. Social media, while widely used, is not a reliable or official record system, as it lacks control over information dissemination and cannot guarantee consistent delivery of official information (Villodre, 2024), which **may hinder** compliance with transparency requirements under Executive Order No. 2 and the 1987 Philippine Constitution on public access to information. In addition, manual documentation practices make data management inefficient and difficult to analyze, limiting the ability of administrators to monitor participation and evaluate program outcomes effectively, which affects accountability expected under Republic Act No. 6713. Furthermore, the use of **multiple non-integrated tools** leads to inconsistent records and data gaps, negatively affecting service delivery and decision-making (Mao & Zhu, 2025), which contradicts the goals of efficient and streamlined government services under Republic Act No. 11032 and the transition to integrated digital governance under Republic Act No. 12254.

In response to these legal, operational, and technological challenges, this study proposes the development of **LYDO Connect: Youth Information, Engagement, and Transparency Management System**, a centralized web-based Progressive Web Application (PWA). The system is designed to improve the dissemination of youth-related information, enable systematic monitoring of youth participation and program outcomes, and provide a **real-time** transparency platform that complies with existing laws on data privacy, transparency, cybersecurity, and e-governance. By integrating these legal frameworks into its design, **LYDO Connect aims to strengthen accountability, enhance public trust, and support more efficient and inclusive youth governance.**

PROJECT RATIONALE - DANI

Effective governance of youth development programs requires the systematic management of program information, participation records, and administrative reports. Local Youth Development Offices (LYDOs), which are established to coordinate youth programs and support Sangguniang Kabataan (SK) initiatives, must maintain organized documentation and transparent monitoring of youth-related activities. However, the management of youth program information and participation records is often conducted through communication platforms and manually organized documents, which limits the ability of administrators to monitor youth engagement, evaluate program implementation, and maintain consolidated records for reporting and accountability.

These limitations highlight the need for a more integrated and structured system that can support the efficient management of youth-related data and processes. Without a centralized

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platform, information remains fragmented, participation data is difficult to analyze, and administrative processes become more dependent on manual effort.

In response, this project proposes the development of LYDO Connect: Youth Information, Engagement, and Transparency Management System, a web-based platform implemented as a Progressive Web Application (PWA) designed to centralize youth program information, participation monitoring, and transparency reporting, while providing data-driven insights that support decision-making for administrators. The system also supports youth participants by providing a centralized platform where they can access program information, register for activities, and track their participation.

The development of this system aligns with the objectives of the Bachelor of Science in Information Technology (BSIT) program by applying principles of system design, software development, and information management to address real-world governance needs, while supporting the Polytechnic University of the Philippines' mission of promoting technology-driven solutions that contribute to community development and improved public service delivery.

STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM - ALY

Local Youth Development Offices (LYDOs) play a critical role in empowering the youth and delivering government programs at the local level. However, the **absence of a centralized platform** has created systemic gaps that hinder their effectiveness across three key areas.

First, youth **access to information remains inconsistent and unreliable**. Many LYDOs rely on **social media platforms** as their primary channel for disseminating announcements, programs, and services. While social media offers accessibility and reach, **it is not a dependable channel** for official government communication, making it an **insufficient** foundation for public administration.

Second, there is **no systematic mechanism for monitoring youth engagement and program outcomes**. Without a **dedicated system to track participation trends** and measure the impact of youth programs, LYDOs are unable to identify the factors that drive or hinder youth engagement, limiting their capacity for data-informed decision-making and program improvement.

Third, public **transparency is compromised**. As a public administration, LYDOs are **obligated** to make government information accessible to citizens. Yet most offices lack a centralized platform

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through which the public can access relevant information, undermining accountability and civic trust.

Taken together, these gaps reflect a broader problem: LYDOs currently operate through fragmented, manual, and largely informal tools that prevent any systematic connection between the office and the youth it serves. This underscores the need for a centralized, web-based platform that can consolidate information dissemination, track youth engagement and program outcomes, and uphold transparency for the public.

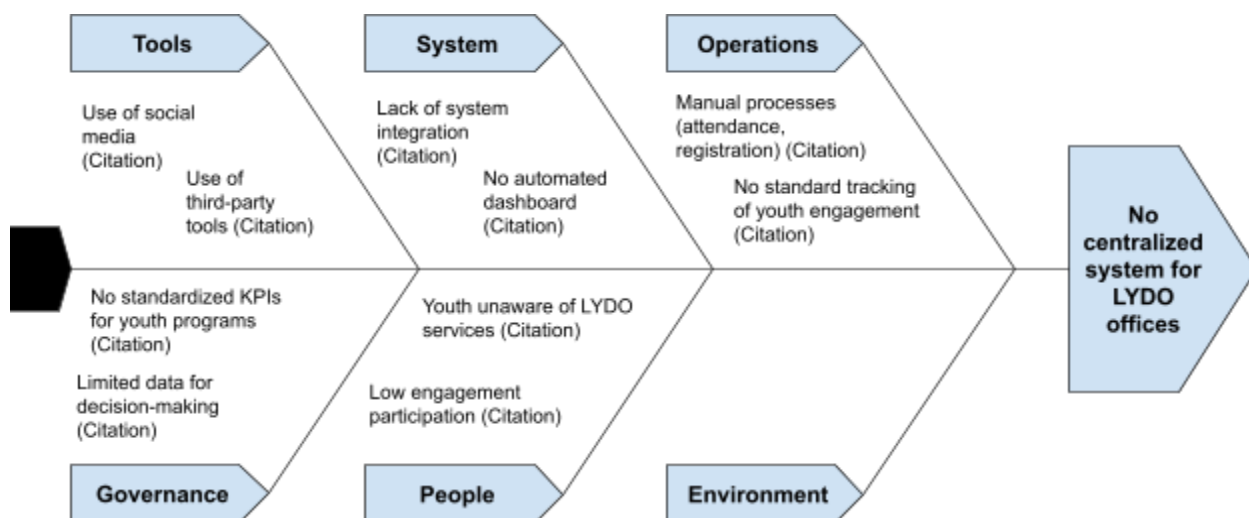


Figure 1: Fishbone Diagram

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY

General Objective

To design and develop a centralized web-based Progressive Web Application (PWA) for Local Youth Development Offices (LYDOs) that streamlines the dissemination of youth-related information and LYDO services, enables systematic monitoring of youth engagement and program outcomes, and promotes public transparency through integrated administrative and user-facing web platforms supported by a shared database system.

Specific Objectives

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- To provide users with a centralized and reliable access to LYDO information on programs, events, organizations, and services.
- To enable users to participate in LYDO programs, events, and organizations, while allowing administrators to systematically monitor youth engagement and program outcomes.
- To make LYDO governance records, compliance documents, and relevant public data accessible to youths, while enabling them to submit service requests and track request status.
- To equip administrators with tools to manage and maintain end-to-end system operations, including content updates, access management, record-keeping, integration with other government or partner data sources, and audit tracking.
- To evaluate the overall quality of the system using the ISO/IEC 25010 software quality model and verify compliance with applicable data privacy, transparency, and youth governance standards.

PROPOSED SYSTEM SOLUTION - TADZ

This study will propose the development of LYDO Connect: Youth Information, Engagement, and Transparency Management System, a Progressive Web Application (PWA) designed to centralize youth governance services, participation records, and public information into a single platform. The system will address the challenges experienced by Local Youth Development Offices (LYDOs), where information dissemination, engagement tracking, and transparency reporting are handled through fragmented and decentralized channels such as social media, manual records, and spreadsheets. These conditions result in inconsistent access to information, difficulty in monitoring youth participation and program outcomes, and limited public access to transparency-related records.

The main purpose of LYDO Connect will be to improve the accessibility, organization, and monitoring of youth governance services while strengthening transparency and accountability. The platform will provide a centralized platform for accessing youth programs, events, governance-related information, and public records.

Intended Users

- Youth Participants – to discover programs, register for activities, and track participation
- General Citizens – to access transparency records, reports, and public advisories
- Local Youth Leaders and Community Stakeholders – to view participation and compliance-related information

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- LYDO Personnel (Administrators) – to manage content, records, and user interactions

Major Features of the System

- Centralized youth programs and event information
- Unified registration for activities and participation
- Youth organization directory
- User profiles with role-based access
- Transparency and disclosure portal
- Participation and engagement records
- Citizen desk for concerns and feedback
- Administrative dashboard for managing data and reports
- Audit and Accountability Support

General Technology Platform

LYDO Connect will be developed as a Progressive Web Application (PWA), allowing access through web browsers on desktop and mobile devices. The platform will provide a responsive and accessible interface for users while supporting centralized data management and information access.

SCOPE AND LIMITATIONS - NAMI

The scope will include the following:

This study focuses on the development of LYDO Connect, a youth information, engagement, and transparency management system designed for **selected** Local Youth Development Offices (LYDOs) within Metro Manila. The system consists of two platforms: a user platform for youth participants and organizations, and an administrative platform for LYDO administrators.

The user platform enables registered users (youth participants, youth organizations, and **LYDO administrators?**) to access full system features, which include **program registration** and profile management. It also supports unregistered users (public users) who are limited to viewing public content, which includes transparency-related information and publicly available services.

The administrative platform enables organizations to manage youth program information, participation tracking, and transparency reporting. All data utilized in the system will be sourced from the **selected** LYDO offices within Metro Manila.

The system will not:

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1. Replace the full digital operations of the LGU or cover unrelated government offices and services
2. Include payment processing, scholarship fund processing, formal e-signature approval workflows, or full integration with existing government databases and systems
3. Function independently without internet connectivity, cloud services, external tools, and timely data encoding or uploading by authorized administrators
4. Provide full access to administrative features for **registered and unregistered users**, as these remain restricted to LYDO administrators only.
5. The study is limited to selected LYDOs within Metro Manila and does not yet cover other regions or nationwide deployment
6. Guarantee that findings and system applicability will directly extend to other LYDOs outside Metro Manila, as the data and implementation are based solely on selected LYDO offices within the region.

METHODOLOGY - DANI TADZ

The methodology section provides a brief overview of how the study will be conducted. It includes the SLDC model, research design, data-gathering methods such as interviews or surveys, and the system development approach to be employed. The discussion should be concise and high-level, as detailed procedures will be presented in the full proposal.

Please include **use case diagrams** here.

Figure 2: Use Case Diagram

EXPECTED OUTPUTS - ALY NAMI

This section outlines the tangible deliverables of the project. These may include a functional IT system, technical and user documentation, and system evaluation results. The expected outputs should be clearly stated and aligned with the project objectives.

Primary Deliverables

a. LYDO Connect System (Public and Admin Portal)

A fully functional web-based platform for youth engagement and administrative management.

b. Centralized Shared Database System

A unified database supporting data storage and synchronization for both portals.

c. Source Code Repository

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Version-controlled project files containing frontend, backend, and database scripts.

Secondary Deliverables

a. Project Manuscript

A comprehensive document detailing the study's background, methodology, system development, and findings.

b. Technical Documentation

A technical guide describing the system architecture, database design, and implementation processes for developers.

c. User Manual / User Guide

An instructional material designed to help both users and administrators navigate the system's features and use the system effectively.

d. System Evaluation Result

A summarized report presenting the system's performance, usability, and effectiveness based on conducted evaluations.

SIGNIFICANCE OF THE STUDY - DAN!

This study will provide significant benefits by developing LYDO Connect: Youth Information, Engagement, and Transparency Management System, a centralized web-based platform designed to streamline LYDO services, engagement monitoring, and transparency reporting for Local Youth Development Offices (LYDOs).

- **For Local Youth Development Offices (LYDOs)**, the system will support transparency and reporting by providing tools such as a transparency board, participation monitoring, and organized program reports, helping administrators track youth programs and evaluate their impact more effectively. By reducing reliance on manual documentation and scattered records, which can lead to inconsistent record-keeping, difficulty in consolidating information, and delays in retrieving program data, the system enables administrators to maintain more organized and accessible records of youth program activities.
- ~~**For local youth organizations**, the system will provide a centralized platform to coordinate activities, manage program participation, and access relevant youth development information. It will help youth leaders organize events, monitor member engagement, and collaborate more effectively with LYDOs and other stakeholders. By improving access to information and participation records, the system supports better planning, implementation, and evaluation of youth-led initiatives.~~

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- **For youth participants**, the system will provide easier access to youth programs and activities, allowing them to discover events, register for programs, and track their participation history. This improves the visibility of youth initiatives and encourages greater participation by providing a dedicated platform where opportunities for engagement are easier to find and access.
- **For general youth**, the system will improve accessibility to publicly available youth-related information, including announcements, transparency records, reports, and service-related updates. Even without registration, citizens may access relevant public information through the platform, thereby promoting greater transparency, awareness, and public trust in youth governance initiatives.
- **For local government units (LGUs)**, the system will improve transparency and accessibility of information related to youth programs, activities, and community initiatives. Through consolidated participation data and program reports, the platform can support better monitoring, evaluation, and planning of youth development initiatives.
- **For future researchers**, the study may serve as a reference for the development of digital platforms related to e-government systems, youth participation monitoring, and transparency initiatives in local governance. It also contributes insights into how digital systems can enhance youth engagement and transparency in public sector programs.

REVIEW OF RELATED LITERATURE - ALY

This section presents a thematic discussion of existing studies, systems, technologies, and frameworks related to the proposed project. This section demonstrates the students' understanding of current solutions and identifies gaps that the proposed system seeks to address.

—Include 2 RRLs, identify theme para ma-thematic natin later

Theme 1: Transparency and Accountability in Local Governance

Theme 2: Youth Participation, Engagement, and Barriers in Local Governance

Theme 3: E-Government and Digital Platforms for Local Service Delivery

—Dani

Theme 1: Right to Information and Digital Transparency in Governance

Access to public information is a fundamental element of democratic governance and is recognized in the Philippine Constitution under the Right to Information (RTI). RTI allows

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citizens to access information on matters of public concern and serves as a mechanism for strengthening transparency, accountability, and citizen participation in governance. According to Oroña-Cabagay et al. (2025), RTI plays a significant role in promoting open governance by ensuring that government information is accessible to the public and by enabling citizens to monitor government actions.

The study explored the legal foundations and institutional practices related to the implementation of RTI in the Philippines. It highlighted the importance of the Freedom of Information (FOI) Program and the electronic Freedom of Information (eFOI) system as digital platforms that allow citizens to request and access government records. These platforms improve transparency by providing easier access to government documents and promoting public participation in governance. This concept is relevant to the proposed LYDO Connect system, which aims to support transparency in youth governance by providing accessible information on youth programs, participation records, and activity reports managed by Local Youth Development Offices.

However, the study also identified several challenges in implementing RTI, including bureaucratic complexity, technological limitations, and institutional resistance. These challenges highlight the need for improved digital systems that simplify access to public information and support open governance initiatives. The proposed LYDO Connect system addresses these limitations by providing a structured digital platform where youth program information, participation data, and transparency reports can be organized and accessed more efficiently, reducing reliance on fragmented communication channels and manual documentation.

Theme 2: E-Government Initiatives in Local Governance

The adoption of electronic government (e-government) systems has become an important strategy for improving governance, administrative efficiency, and public service delivery in local government units. E-government platforms enable government agencies to utilize digital technologies to streamline processes, improve transparency, and enhance communication between public institutions and citizens.

Barrios and Moreno (2024) examined the effectiveness of e-government initiatives in addressing governance challenges in the City of Zamboanga, Philippines. Using a mixed-methods approach, the study analyzed how digital tools such as e-services portals and open data platforms contributed to improving administrative processes and public service delivery. The findings showed that the use of digital platforms helped reduce processing time, improve

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transparency, and support more efficient management of government services. These findings are relevant to the proposed study because digital systems can support more efficient coordination and documentation of government programs. In the context of youth governance, a dedicated information system can assist Local Youth Development Offices in organizing youth program information, monitoring participation, and maintaining structured records of youth initiatives.

Despite these improvements, the study also identified challenges such as the digital divide, resistance to organizational change, and concerns related to data security. These limitations highlight the need for digital governance systems that are accessible, adaptable to existing administrative processes, and capable of protecting sensitive information. The proposed LYDO Connect system addresses these challenges by providing a web-based platform that can be accessed through standard internet browsers, reducing technical barriers to system adoption. The system also introduces structured tools for managing youth programs and participation records, which can gradually replace manual documentation practices and support the transition to more efficient digital workflows. In addition, the implementation of authentication and role-based access control mechanisms helps protect administrative data and ensure that sensitive program information is only accessible to authorized users.

Theme 0: Transparency and Accountability in Local Governance Performance

Transparency and accountability are essential principles in ensuring effective governance and preventing corruption within public institutions. Ong and Gabriel (2018) emphasized that these principles play a critical role in improving the performance of local legislative bodies. Their study assessed the level of transparency and accountability among local legislators in five cities in Nueva Ecija, Philippines, and examined how these principles relate to legislative performance. Using a mixed-methods approach and Pearson Product Moment Correlation, the study found that local legislators generally demonstrated adherence to transparency and accountability practices, and that higher levels of observance were associated with increased legislative productivity, as measured by the number of ordinances and resolutions enacted.

The findings highlight that transparency and accountability are not only ethical standards but also practical drivers of improved governance outcomes. Moreover, the study recommended the use of Information and Communications Technology (ICT) as a tool to strengthen these principles by enhancing monitoring mechanisms, improving responsiveness to public demands, and ensuring efficient delivery of services. This is relevant to the proposed LYDO Connect system, as it integrates digital tools to support transparency in youth governance. By providing

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accessible records of youth programs, participation data, and activity reports, the system contributes to accountability and allows stakeholders to evaluate the effectiveness of youth initiatives. In this way, the system aligns with the study's recommendation of leveraging ICT to improve governance performance and public service delivery at the local level.

—Tadz

Theme 3: Youth Participation, Engagement, and Barriers in Local Governance

Youth participation plays an important role in local governance because it allows young people to take part in community activities, decision-making, and leadership development. When youth are actively involved, they become more aware of social issues, develop a sense of responsibility, and build stronger connections with their communities. However, for youth participation to be effective, it should not only focus on involvement but also consider how activities are organized, supported, and assessed over time.

Collins, Augsberger, and Gecker (2017) examined youth councils in municipal governments by looking at their activities, outcomes, and challenges. The study found that youth councils give young individuals opportunities to participate in governance through activities such as attending meetings, conducting outreach, engaging in community service, and contributing to local initiatives. As a result, participants developed better civic awareness, leadership skills, confidence, and decision-making abilities. However, the study also pointed out several challenges, including strong adult influence in decision-making, limited diversity among participants, difficulties in outreach, and organizational constraints that can limit meaningful youth engagement.

However, while the study clearly identifies the benefits and challenges of youth participation, it does not provide a specific system or mechanism for systematically tracking participation, monitoring engagement, or addressing these barriers through structured data management. This gap highlights the need for a digital solution that can support the organization, monitoring, and evaluation of youth participation at the local level. These findings are relevant to the present study because they show that while youth participation programs are beneficial, they also face challenges that can affect their overall effectiveness. In many cases, participation is not systematically documented or evaluated, making it difficult to identify gaps and improve programs. The proposed LYDO Connect system responds to this need by providing a centralized platform that organizes youth program data, tracks participation, and supports transparency reporting. Through these features, the system can help Local Youth Development

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Offices better manage youth activities, monitor engagement, and improve the implementation of youth programs.

Theme 4: Government Information Websites as Foundations for Accessible Service Delivery

Government information websites serve as the public-facing foundation of digital government service delivery because they organize official information into a form that citizens can more easily find, understand, and use. When government-related information is scattered across different platforms or communicated through disconnected channels, users may struggle to identify official procedures, locate reliable records, and access services efficiently. For this reason, the quality of government information websites matters not only for communication but also for accessibility, trust, and the overall usability of public services.

The Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD, 2023) explains that effective government information websites help improve communication between institutions and the public, simplify interactions, and support better access to services for citizens and businesses. The report emphasizes that these platforms should be user-centered, authoritative, easy to navigate, comprehensive, searchable, and regularly improved based on user needs. It also notes that government websites may evolve into more advanced digital platforms, including transactional portals that allow users not only to view information, but also to interact with services in a more organized and responsive environment. These principles show that a government website is not merely a posting page, but an important digital structure for making public information and services clearer and more accessible.

This literature is relevant to the proposed system because it highlights the importance of having a centralized and well-structured platform for delivering public information and services. Similar to the issues identified by OECD (2023), current practices in Local Youth Development Offices rely on fragmented communication channels such as social media, spreadsheets, and manual documentation, which can lead to inconsistency and difficulty in accessing reliable information. The proposed LYDO Connect system addresses these challenges by providing a web-based platform where youth programs, participation records, and reports are organized and accessible in one place. By doing so, the system supports improved accessibility, clearer communication, and more efficient service delivery for both youth participants and administrators.

—Nami

Theme 5: Strengthening Youth Participation and Community Development

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The Local Youth Development Offices serve as the main organizations to implement youth programs while encouraging youth participation in community service projects. The Sangguniang Kabataan Reform Act (RA 10742) established LYDOs to execute youth programs and assist young groups, while they promote leadership development and engagement activities.

Valenzuela (2025) conducted a study that examined the operational methods of the Local Youth Development Office in Lumban, Laguna. The study evaluated five aspects of LYDO operations, including inclusiveness, program development, community partnership, resource provision, and advocacy. The study used descriptive statistics and Pearson's correlation coefficient to determine the proposed relationship between variables.

The findings of the study revealed that the strongest relationships were observed to be between program development and youth participation, and between community partnerships and community cohesion. However, the findings also suggest the need for better monitoring systems for youth participation and program implementation, which will improve the assessment of program impacts and guide improvements. This limitation is relevant to the present study since the proposed LYDO Connect system aims to provide a centralized platform that manages youth programs, participation tracking, and transparency reports. Thus, solves the monitoring and evaluation problem through digital record management of program operations and participant records.

Theme 6: Youth Perception of SK Effectiveness

The Sangguniang Kabataan is a significant youth organization in the Philippines that represents the voices and interests of young people while encouraging their involvement in local governance. Examining how young people perceive SK programs is important in determining how effective these initiatives are in meeting the needs and concerns of the youth.

Castillo et al. (2024) conducted a study that examined the demographics, perceptions, and participation of youth in relation to the effectiveness of the Sangguniang Kabataan. The researchers used survey data to study youth participation levels while determining which factors impact young people's involvement in SK-led programs and activities. The findings showed that respondents acknowledge the significance of SK as a youth representation system for local governance. However, there are multiple areas that need improvement for better effectiveness that can be addressed through better implementation of youth-focused programs and initiatives.

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The study also identified barriers to youth participation, including ineffective communication about the program and those who could not participate because of time restrictions. To address these, the researchers recommend improving communication methods with young people to increase awareness and engagement in the SK programs and activities. In line with this recommendation, the proposed system focuses on improving communication with youth through a centralized platform, which enables users to easily access program information, events, organizations, and participation opportunities.

Theme 7: Data Governance and Privacy in Youth Information Systems

Digital public service systems need their data management and privacy protection systems to establish trust between users and properly handle data according to ethical standards. Data governance systems at Local Youth Development Offices (LYDOs) protect sensitive data which includes information about youth participants, organizations, and program activities from unauthorized access and unethical handling. Governance frameworks establish requirements for personal data handling which include collection, storage, and processing to meet legal standards while enabling government systems to operate in an open manner that builds public trust.

Kiram et al. (2025) studied data governance and privacy practices in Sulu, Philippines, to show how digital public service delivery creates trust and enables accountable government operations. The study showed that effective data governance requires organizations to establish data protection policies and secure information systems and accountability mechanisms and methods to maintain public data transparency. The study showed that organizations must implement privacy measures according to the Data Privacy Act of 2012 requirements for protecting citizen data and building trust in digital government services.

The findings are relevant to the present study as the proposed LYDO Connect system involves managing youth-related data, including participation records and organizational information. The study supports the integration of strong data governance and privacy features within the system to ensure secure data handling and restricted access to authorized users only. The implementation of these measures will enable LYDO Connect to establish trust, accountability, and transparency while protecting youth program data according to data protection laws.

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Theme 8: Social Media Limitations for Official Communication

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Villodre (2024) explores the notion of how public administrations use social media as a medium for transparency and official communication. In this article, Villodre examined three (3) models of social media-mediated transparency in city councils across Spain, analyzing how social media is used in the public sector. The study investigated how social media platforms function as tools for transparency and communication in public administrations. Villodre found that information disseminated through social media platforms is usually framed positively and that social media-mediated transparency poses challenges due to a lack of control over actors that affect the nature of information and communication. In conclusion, the study suggests that social media is not a reliable channel for official government communications.

This is relevant to our study as it relates to the current communication setup of Local Youth Development Offices (LYDO) in the Philippines, which relies on social media platforms such as Facebook pages and Messenger groups to manage youth-oriented programs and youth participants. Just as Villodre found that public administrations lose control over information and communication when using social media platforms, LYDO faces similar limitations in its communication practices. Factors such as program announcements can be missed or buried in feeds, and there is no mechanism to ensure that information consistently reaches the youth. This directly connects to the communication challenges observed across public administrations in Spain, Villodre identified: a lack of control over how information is disseminated to citizens.

Although the study examines the transparency and communication limitations of social media in public administrations, it does not address how a dedicated web-based system could restore control over administrative information, and communication is no longer dependent solely on a social media platform.

Theme 9: Web-Based Information Systems for Public Offices

Mao and Zhu (2025) explore the notion of how e-government integration contributes to the quality and equality of local public services. In this article, Mao and Zhu examined the relationship between integrated e-government platforms and the delivery of public services across local governments in China, analyzing how digital integration affects both service quality and equitable access among citizens. The study investigated how the consolidation of government services into unified digital platforms influences the efficiency, accessibility, and fairness of public service delivery at the local level. Mao and Zhu found that e-government integration significantly improves the overall quality of local public services and contributes to reducing inequality in service access, particularly in areas where administrative fragmentation previously hindered consistent delivery. In conclusion, the study suggests that integrated digital

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government platforms are effective mechanisms for enhancing both the standard and the equitable distribution of public services.

This is relevant to our study as it relates to the current operational setup of Local Youth Development Offices (LYDO) in the Philippines, which manages youth-oriented programs and participant records through fragmented and non-integrated means such as manual documentation and disconnected social media platforms. Just as Mao and Zhu found that e-government integration improves service quality and reduces inequality in access, LYDO faces similar inefficiencies stemming from the absence of a unified system to manage youth programs, participant data, and service delivery. Factors such as inconsistent record-keeping, lack of centralized program tracking, and unequal access to program information among youth participants reflect the same fragmentation that Mao and Zhu identified as barriers to quality public service. This directly connects to the core operational challenges observed in local government youth offices that Mao and Zhu identified: the absence of an integrated digital platform leads to uneven and inefficient public service delivery.

Although the study examines how e-government integration enhances service quality and equality at the local government level, it does not address how a dedicated web-based system specifically designed for youth development offices could operationalize this integration at the program level.

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